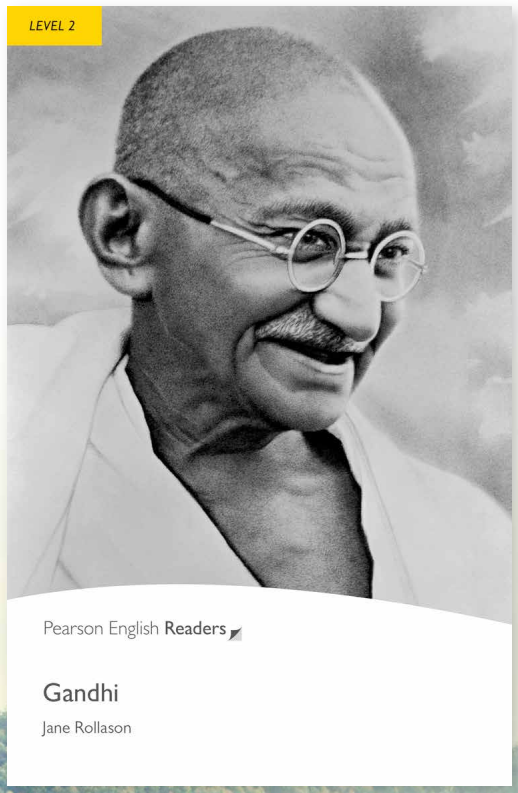


PREPARATION

1 **Look and the book cover and answer the questions:**

see

1 Look at the picture. Who is this man?
2 Describe him.

think

3 Write a list of all the words you think of when you think of him.
4 The British ruled India in the 1900s. What do you think life was like for Indian people?

wonder

5 What will you learn in a book about Gandhi's life?
6 Think of three questions about Gandhi.

The Salt March

The British **ruled** India. The British didn't want India to be **independent**. Gandhi wanted the British to leave.

"We have to do something big," said Gandhi.

India is a hot country and life without salt isn't possible. There is ocean to the west, south, and east of India and there is salt on the beaches. But at that time people had to pay money to the British when they took salt. "This law hurts poor people more than rich people," thought Gandhi.

On March 12, 1930, with seventy-eight men and women, sixty-one-year-old Gandhi started to walk to Dandi, a small place by the Indian Ocean, 385 kilometres away. They walked twenty kilometres every day. Thousands of people stood by the road and shouted Gandhi's name. Indians everywhere listened to their radios. "We are **marching** in the name of God," said Gandhi. They called it the "Salt March".

They arrived at Dandi on April 6. Gandhi walked onto the beach, took some salt in his hand and showed it to the people. "I am breaking the **law**," he said. Indians around the country went to the ocean and took salt to sell in the cities, but they didn't pay any money to the British. They were breaking the law so the police put thousands of them in **prison**. After four weeks, there were 100,000 people in prison. On May 5 the British put Gandhi in prison too. "Good," he thought, "Now I can get some sleep."

In the eyes of the world, the British looked stupid after the Salt March. Prison wasn't the answer. They knew they couldn't rule India without the help of the Indian people. In 1931, the British invited Gandhi to London for talks.

GLOSSARY

to rule *v.* to have the power to make the rules in a country
independent *adj.* free, no one tells you what to do
march *v./n.* to walk for a long time/a long walk
law *n.* a rule you must not break
prison *n.* the place people go when they break the law

COMPREHENSION

2 LL2.01 **Listen and read the text. Choose the correct option to answer the questions, a), b), c) or d).**

1 What did Gandhi think of the British?
- **a)** He wanted to work with them.
- **b)** He wanted to be British.
- **c)** He wanted the British to go home.
- **d)** He wanted war with Britain.

2 Which option best describes what the Indian people thought about the Salt March?
- **a)** They were happy about it.
- **b)** They wanted Gandhi to stop it.
- **c)** They didn't know about it.
- **d)** They wanted more salt.

3 Why was the Salt March important?
- **a)** Gandhi showed people how to find salt.
- **b)** Gandhi sold salt and made lots of money. He gave the money to poor people.
- **c)** Gandhi showed people how to cook with salt.
- **d)** Gandhi showed people how to break a British law.

4 Many Indian people took salt from the beaches. What happened to them?
- **a)** They became rich.
- **b)** They became ill.
- **c)** They went to prison.
- **d)** Gandhi said thank you to them.

5 What happened after the Salt March?
- **a)** Britain looked less strong.
- **b)** India became independent.
- **c)** Gandhi was ill in prison.
- **d)** nothing

CLIL CONNECTION

History

3 **Find out about Gandhi's life.**

1 Write a timeline with the important dates in his life, e.g. March 12, 1930 – started the Salt March.

2 Did you find the answers to your questions from Ex 1 Question 6?

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION

4 **Think about what you know about Nelson Mandela. Compare the two leaders. How were their lives the same? How were they different?**

SPEAKING

5 **Peaceful protest is one way to change things you don't like, for example going on a march like Gandhi. Work in pairs.**

1 Make a list of types of peaceful protest.

2 Think of something you'd like to change. Why do you want to change it? Try and persuade your partner why it is a good idea to protest for this change.

